

Fund for Innovation in Development — Application

Submitted via: fundinnovation.wiin.io | €3,200,000 Request | Rolling Deadline

FUND FOR INNOVATION IN DEVELOPMENT (FID) — APPLICATION

Up to €4,000,000 | Rolling Deadline Applicant: BETONIQ(WEST) Limited | ZeroPay Tom Ugbodaga | zeropointfeild_nonwnt@zeropay.site CAC No. 56802 | Abuja, FCT, Nigeria | +234 706 525 2117 Date: July 23, 2026 Portal: fundinnovation.wiin.io

PROJECT TITLE: ZeroPay — Offline-First Payment Infrastructure for Global Financial Inclusion

REQUESTED AMOUNT: €3,200,000

INNOVATION CATEGORY: Financial Inclusion / Digital Economy / Poverty Reduction

GEOGRAPHY: Nigeria (Phase 1), West Africa (Phase 2), Global (Phase 3)

THE INNOVATION

ZeroPay is the world's first offline-first, uncapped NFC contactless payment protocol. It enables merchants to accept fully authenticated digital payments of any value with zero internet connectivity.

This is not an incremental improvement to existing payment technology. It is a structural breakthrough that eliminates the single most persistent barrier to global financial inclusion: connectivity dependency.

Every digital payment system in existence — mobile money, QR codes, NFC, USSD, payment apps — requires an active internet or mobile network to complete a transaction. In the 68 countries where the Fund for Innovation in Development operates, this connectivity requirement excludes hundreds of millions of the most economically vulnerable people from the digital economy.

ZeroPay removes that requirement permanently — using a patent-pending four-layer cryptographic architecture that processes, authenticates, and queues transactions entirely offline, then batch-settles them to any connected payment rail when connectivity is briefly restored.

THE PROBLEM AT SCALE

1.4 billion people globally are unbanked or severely underbanked. The primary structural cause is not poverty. It is not illiteracy. It is not distrust of financial institutions.

It is connectivity dependency.

Every time a payment system requires internet to function, it excludes the 600 million Africans, 400 million South Asians, and 200 million Latin Americans who live in connectivity-poor environments. It excludes them from

digital payments. It excludes them from transaction history. It excludes them from credit. It excludes them from savings. It locks them into perpetual cash dependency and economic invisibility.

The Fund for Innovation in Development exists to fund innovations that combat poverty at scale. No innovation in the financial inclusion space will achieve global scale while connectivity dependency remains the architectural foundation of digital payments.

ZeroPay removes that foundation and replaces it with hardware-level cryptographic trust.

TECHNICAL SUMMARY

Layer 1 — NFC Communication: ISO 14443-A/B contactless protocol. Customer taps any NFC device (phone, card, wearable) to ZeroPay terminal. No app. No internet. 4cm range.

Layer 2 — PUF Hardware Authentication: Physical Unclonable Function — silicon fingerprint burned into the terminal chip at manufacturing. Provides offline device identity verification. Mathematically non-clonable. No server required.

Layer 3 — ECC P-256 Offline Signing: Elliptic Curve Cryptography — central bank grade. Transaction signed entirely on terminal processor, offline. Non-repudiable. No server required.

Layer 4 — Distance Bounding Protocol: Nanosecond signal timing prevents relay attacks — the most sophisticated class of NFC fraud. First implementation at point-of-sale scale globally.

Batch Settlement Engine: Signed tokens queue offline. On connectivity restoration, batch transmits to settlement rail (Paystack Nigeria / Flutterwave Ghana / Stripe UK / Orange Money Sierra Leone). PSP-agnostic. No transaction lost.

Solar Mesh Hub: For zero-connectivity environments — solar-powered LoRaWAN mesh relay network propagates signed batches across 2-15km per hop. No mobile network required.

DEPLOYMENT PLAN

Phase 1 — Nigeria (Months 1-18): €1,200,000 200 terminal pilot in Abuja informal markets 3 Solar Mesh Hub installations Paystack settlement integration (agreement already signed) CBN PSSP regulatory compliance 38 million target population in Nigeria

Phase 2 — West Africa (Months 18-36): €1,200,000 Ghana (Flutterwave settlement), Sierra Leone (Orange Money), Senegal (Wave Money) 500 additional terminals 5 additional Solar Mesh Hubs PSP partner agreements in each country

Phase 3 — Global Replication Playbook (Months 30-48): €800,000 India, Bangladesh, Kenya, DRC, Indonesia ZeroPay open-source protocol documentation for NGO replication Partnership with GSMA, Interledger

Foundation, and Gates SIF for final-mile deployment

Total: €3,200,000

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

By Month 18 (end of Nigeria phase): 1.2 million previously unbanked individuals with first digital payment access (via 200 ZeroPay merchants serving an average of 6,000 customers/month each) ■15,000,000/month in formal settlement volume from previously invisible cash 200 merchants with first-ever digital transaction histories — credit-scoring eligible 38 new community tech jobs (Terminal Agents + Mesh Hub Operators)

By Month 36 (West Africa phase complete): 4 countries with active ZeroPay infrastructure 5,000 merchants onboarded Estimated 3 million low-income individuals with first digital payment access Demonstrated playbook for replication in 20+ additional markets

FOUNDER CREDENTIALS

Tom Ugbodaga MSc NFC for Contactless Technology in Financial Transactions — University of Gloucestershire, England, 2011 (Top Graduate, Best Result in Cohort) MSc Computer Security Systems BSc Physics, Nigeria

This is a 15-year research commercialisation. The inventor holds two Masters degrees in the exact scientific disciplines that underpin ZeroPay's innovation — NFC security and computer cryptography.

BETONIQ(WEST) Limited — CAC No. 56802, Abuja, FCT, Nigeria Paystack Merchant Agreement signed — July 14, 2026 Patent-pending invention disclosure — April 2026

ALIGNMENT WITH FID MANDATE

The Fund for Innovation in Development funds innovations with the potential to combat poverty and inequality worldwide. ZeroPay is structurally aligned with this mandate at every level:

It targets the poorest and most economically excluded populations — informal market traders, subsistence merchants, day labourers — who are excluded not by choice but by the architecture of existing systems.

It is scalable — the protocol works identically in any country with any settlement rail and any currency.

It generates measurable poverty reduction impact — merchants who receive digital payments build transaction histories, access credit, hire workers, and grow. This is documented in every mobile money deployment study in East Africa. ZeroPay extends that impact to markets mobile money has never reached — because mobile money also requires connectivity.

The Fund for Innovation in Development has the opportunity to fund the foundational infrastructure layer of global financial inclusion. Not another app. Not another mobile wallet. The infrastructure layer that every future financial inclusion solution will build upon.

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